



Highly pathogenic Avian Influenza in Belgium

Situation and measures in
place

19-20 February 2026

Summary of the outbreaks in Belgium since 01/10/2025

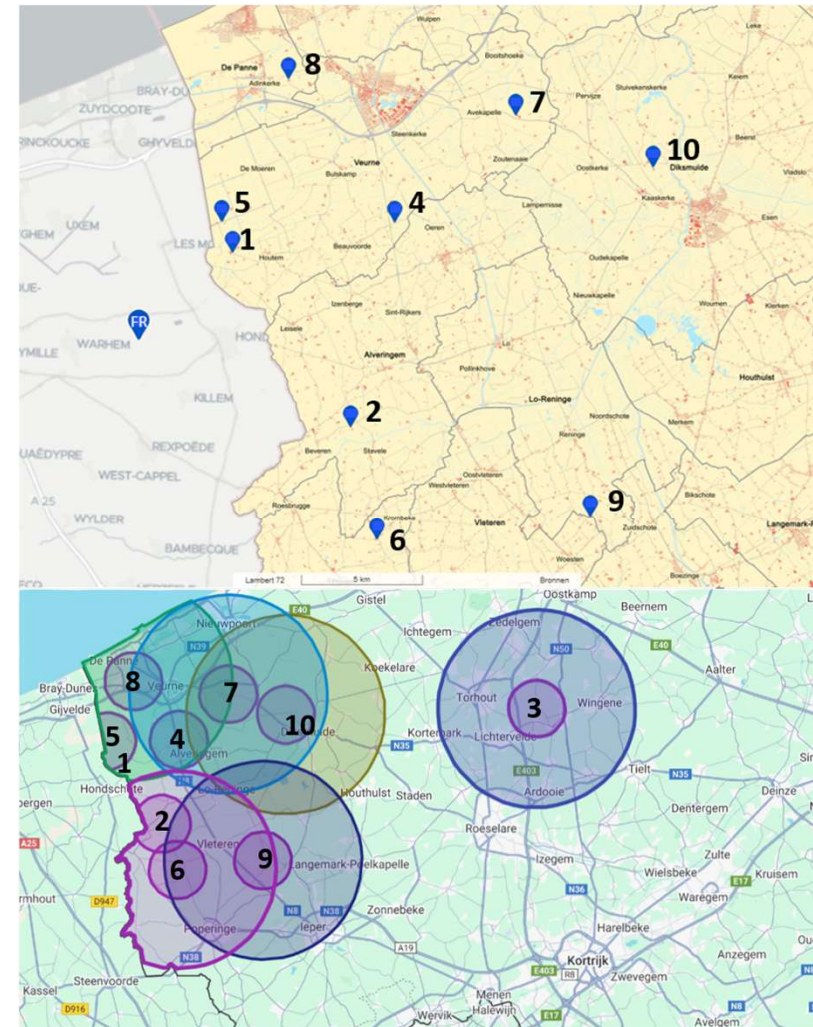
Place	Strain	Date of confirmation	Type holding
Welkenraedt	HPAI H5N1	20/10/2025	Captive birds: hobby holder
Houthulst	HPAI H5N1	22/10/2025	Poultry: broilers and meat turkeys
Weelde	HPAI H5N1	25/10/2025	Poultry: chicken breeders
Dilsen-Stokkem	HPAI H5N1	20/11/2025	Poultry: laying hens
Kinrooi	HPAI H5N1	22/11/2025	Poultry: rearing laying hens
Pelt (1)	HPAI H5N1	23/11/2025	Poultry: laying hens
Pelt (2)	HPAI H5N1	24/11/2025	Poultry: broilers
Gembloux	HPAI H5N1	23/11/2025	Poultry: organic broilers
La Bruyère (1)	HPAI H5N1	23/11/2025	Poultry: chicken breeders
La Bruyère (2)	HPAI H5N1	25/11/2025	Poultry: meat ducks
Oudenaarde	HPAI H5N1	03/12/2025	Captive birds: hobby holder

Summary of the outbreaks in Belgium since 01/10/2025

Place	Strain	Date of confirmation	Type holding
Veurne 1	HPAI H5N1	23/12/2025	Poultry: chicken breeders
Alveringem	HPAI H5N1	9/01/2026	Poultry: chicken breeders
Wingene	HPAI H5N1	9/01/2026	Poultry: meat turkeys
Veurne 2	HPAI H5N1	11/01/2026	Poultry: laying hens
Veurne 3	HPAI H5N1	11/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
Poperinge	HPAI H5N1	13/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
Veurne 4	HPAI H5N1	14/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
De Panne	HPAI H5N1	15/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
Vleteren	HPAI H5N1	17/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
Diksmuide	HPAI H5N1	19/01/2026	Poultry: broilers
Deerlijk	HPAI H5N1	25/01/2026	Poultry: meat turkeys
Tielt	HPAI H5N1	11/02/2026	Captive birds: hobby holder

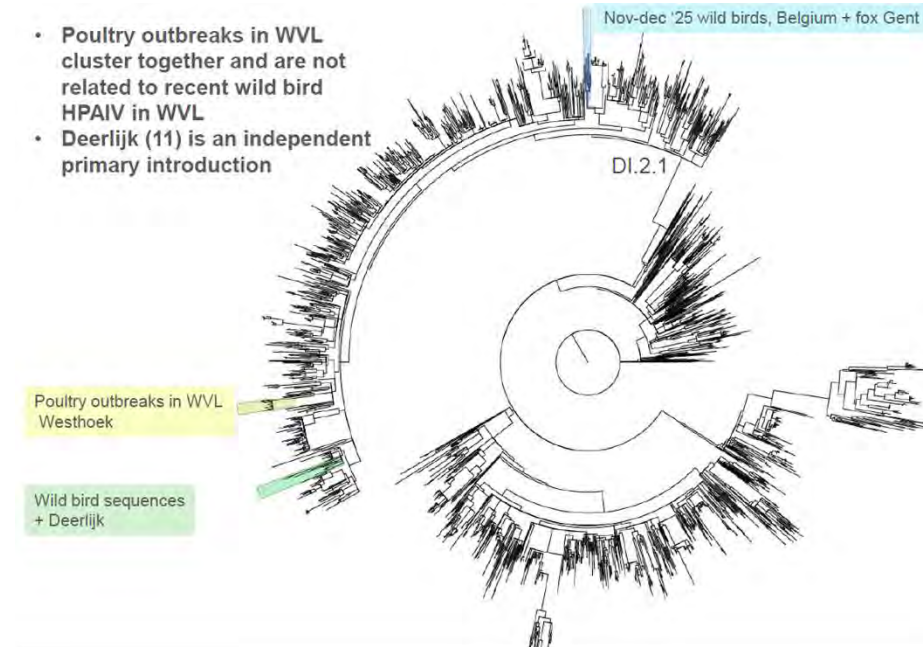
Outbreaks in the Westhoek

Number	Place	Symptomes	Suspicion	Confirmation	Culling
1	Veurne 1	22-12-25	23-12-25	23-12-25	24-12-25
FR	Warhem (France)	29-12-25	30-12-25	31-12-25	05-01-26
2	Alveringem	08-01-26	08-01-26	09-01-26	09-01-26
3	Wingene	08-01-26	09-01-26	09-01-26	10-01-26
4	Veurne 2	11-01-26	11-01-26	11-01-26	12-01-26
5	Veurne 3	10-01-26	11-01-26	11-01-26	12-01-26
6	Poperinge	10-01-26	12-01-26	13-01-26	13-01-26
7	Veurne 4	13-01-26	14-01-26	14-01-26	15-01-26
8	De Panne	14-01-26	15-01-26	15-01-26	16-01-26
9	Vleteren	17-01-26	17-01-26	17-01-26	18-01-26
10	Diksmuide	18-01-26	18-01-26	19-01-26	19-01-26



Outbreaks in the Westhoek

- Phylogenetic analysis:
 - No connection between the Westhoek outbreaks in poultry and wild birds sampled in the same region at this period
 - The strains from outbreaks 1 to 10 in Westhoek in Belgium and in Warhem (France) are close related -> CLUSTER
- Hypothesis
 - No direct or indirect contacts between the outbreak farms
 - Warhem (FR) could be a consequence of Veurne 1 (BE) or originate from the same source (wind from the north-west)
 - The following outbreaks in the Westhoek region in Belgium could be secondary outbreaks caused by the accumulation of the virus in this area and its spread by the wind





Outbreaks of HPAI H5N1 in Poultry Deerlijk

- Deerlijk: Province of West Flanders
- Commercial farm with 26,491 meat turkey
- Confirmation outbreak: 25th January 2026
- Increased mortality
- Source: Independent primarily introduction from the Westhoek cluster





Outbreaks of HPAI H5N1 in hobby holder Tielt

- Tielt: Province of West Flanders
- Hobby holder with 16 captive birds (6 hens and 10 ducks)
- Confirmation outbreak: 25th January 2026
- Increased mortality in five ducks
- Source : contact with wild birds which frequented the pond on the site where the captive birds were raised





Outbreaks of HPAI H5N1

Measures in captive birds and Poultry

- Culling of all captive birds and poultry in all the outbreaks
- Litter removed, cleaning and disinfection
- Protocol for restocking with at least a 3-week sanitary vacuum
 - Repopulation after approval by the FASFC
- Establishment of **Protection** (3 km) and **Surveillance** (10 km) zones around all outbreaks **in poultry**
- Outbreak in captive birds in Tiel: measures only applied in the establishment and no zoning considering:
 - derogation in Commission Delegated Regulation 2020/687/EU
 - type and the small size of the establishment (16 captive birds)
 - localisation (hobby holder isolated and without contacts)
 - increased risk period still implemented in Belgium for professional and hobby holders
 - intensive surveillance still in force for poultry, captive birds and wild birds



Outbreak of HPAI H5N1 in poultry

Additional measures in the whole territory – Increased risk period

- Increased risk period declared on 15 November 2021: measures adapted following the epidemiological situation -> **measures reinforced on the 23rd October 2025** :
 - Mandatory confinement or protection of all poultry and captive birds of registered holdings
 - Mandatory drinking and feeding inside or protected for poultry and captive birds
 - Prohibition of watering of poultry and captive birds with surface water or rainwater
- **Increased daily biosecurity**
- **Increased vigilance**
- Gatherings of poultry and captive birds already forbidden except for hobby poultry non-commercial gatherings



Outbreak of HPAI H5N1 in poultry

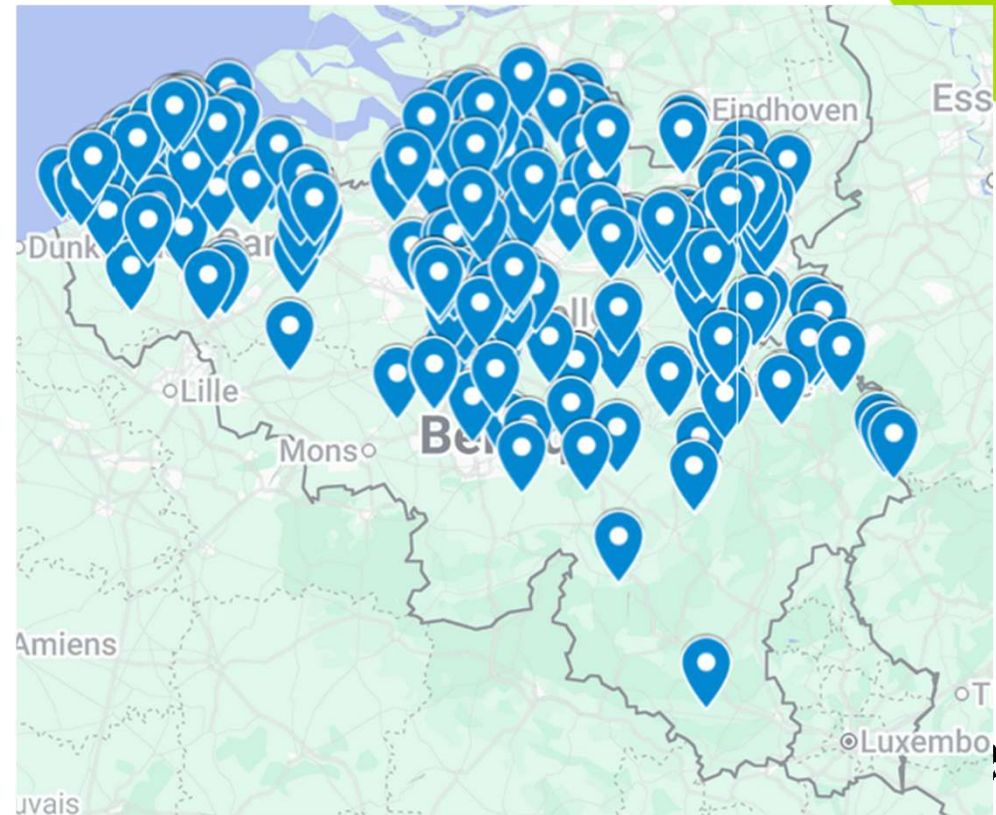
Additional measures in the restricted zone Veurne-Alveringem

- **Increased vigilance in poultry farms since 13 January**
 - If 10 more birds are found dead in a barn or a compartment:
 - The farm veterinarian applies a quick test for AI, or
he/she sends samples for HPAI diagnostics to the lab
 - The farm veterinarian contacts the local control unit of the FASFC by telephone and confirms his findings by e-mail



Outbreak of HPAI in wild birds 1/10/2025 until 13/02/2026

- 412 HPAI H5 cases
 - 362 H5N1 HPAI
 - 50 H5NX HPAI
- 173 different sites



Thank you for your attention

